

Utha USA Website — Project Report

Version 1 "Heritage in Motion" — research, design, features, and roadmap

Prepared August 2026 · For internal review

1. Executive Summary

We are building a modern website for **Utha USA**, a Bangladeshi community organization in the United States. Before designing, we researched **~28 existing Bangladeshi and Bengali community organization websites across America** — their pages, features, and designs. The key finding: **not one of them uses modern web design** (no scroll animations, no motion, mostly 2015-era templates). This gave us a clear opportunity: build the most modern-looking community website in the entire Bangladeshi-American space.

Version 1 is now **built, tested, and running**. It is a fully animated, scroll-driven, mobile-responsive website with placeholder content, ready to receive real photos, names, and event details. Membership and payment features are intentionally left for a future phase.

2. Websites We Studied — and What We Took From Each

We reviewed organizations in New York, Texas, Michigan, California, Georgia, Ohio, Boston, and Florida, plus national bodies (FOBANA, CAB). The most useful references:

Website	Organization	What we took from it
bam-usa.org	Bangladesh Assoc. of Michigan	Feature benchmark. The most complete feature set found (events calendar, member login, directory, gallery, news, donations). It shaped our page list and future roadmap.
badfw.org	Bengali Assoc. of Dallas–Fort Worth	Visual benchmark. The cleanest, most modern site in the space; mixes Bangla and English text. We adopted and extended its bilingual typography idea.
saikat.org	Saikat, San Diego	Card-based event layouts and the membership model where yearly membership includes event access — used in our events design and future membership tiers.
basgh.net	Bangladesh American Society of Greater Houston	Page structure and navigation pattern (events list, membership plans, prominent join/donate buttons).
banglabiswa.org	Bangla-O-Biswa, Boston	How membership benefits are bundled and presented (free entry to flagship events, tier comparison) — reflected in our membership page.
bangladeshsocietyinc.com	Bangladesh Society Inc., New York (est. 1975)	The cultural importance of a visible committee page with names and roles — built into our About page.
baga.net	Bengali Assoc. of Greater Atlanta	Sponsor showcase concept (tiered sponsor logos) — planned for our future sponsors section.
banglaevents.org	Bangla Events (listing portal)	Event listing and calendar presentation patterns.

What no studied website had — our differentiators: scroll-driven animation, parallax, pinned sections, live countdowns, animated statistics, modern typography, and a cohesive designed brand. These come from current international web-design practice (the style used by leading product and campaign sites), not from any community site.

3. The Design — "Heritage Modern"

The design concept joins two things: **Bangladeshi cultural identity** and **current international web design**. Bengal's colors and letterforms, presented with the motion language of a modern product site.

Brand system

- **Colors:** deep Bangladesh green (#006A4E) as the primary, flag red (#F42A41) as the accent, warm cream (#FAF7F0) background, dark ink (#16211C) text — the flag, softened into an elegant palette.
- **Typography:** Space Grotesk (modern English typeface) paired with two Bangla typefaces — Hind Siliguri for interface text and Noto Serif Bengali for display, including the signature giant **উঠা** wordmark.
- **Cultural motifs:** hand-drawn **alpona** (আলপনা) medallions used as decorative elements throughout; a gliding ribbon of festival names in Bangla; Bangla+English section headings on every page.

Motion design (the scroll experience)

- A progress bar at the top fills as the visitor scrolls the page.
- The hero reacts to the scrollbar: the giant **উঠা** wordmark grows and dissolves, the headline slides away, and two alpona medallions rotate — one clockwise, one counter-clockwise — as you scroll.
- A full-width statement lights up **word by word** as it is scrolled through, ending on "আমি বাঙালি" in red.
- The signature section: the page **pins in place** while vertical scrolling drives six full-height festival panels sliding horizontally (Pitha Utshob → Victory Day → Ekushey → Boishakhi Mela → Eid → Picnic).
- Sections rise and scale into view like a curtain; images zoom gently as they pass through the screen; statistics count up; event cards tilt in 3D toward the cursor; the navigation bar turns to frosted glass and shrinks on scroll.
- **Accessibility:** every animation respects the visitor's "reduced motion" system setting, and the whole site is mobile-first responsive.

4. What We Have Now (Version 1 — built and tested)

STATUS Production build passes cleanly: **15 static pages**, fast load (~150 KB first load), running locally; ready to deploy free on Vercel when approved.

Page	What's on it
Home	Animated hero with উঠ wordmark · community statistics with count-up numbers · "Next Up" section with a live countdown clock · Bangla festival marquee · pinned horizontal festival showcase · scroll-zoom culture sections · word-by-word statement · event preview cards · gallery preview · join call-to-action
Events	Six sample events, each with its own page: gradient hero, live countdown, description, venue block. <i>(Sample/placeholder content — real events plug in later.)</i>
Gallery	Masonry photo wall with click-to-open lightbox. <i>(Placeholder tiles until real photos arrive.)</i>
About	Organization story, mission card, three values (Culture · Togetherness · Service), committee grid with roles in English and Bangla.
Membership	Information page with sample tiers — display only, no payments. <i>(Full membership system is a future phase.)</i>
Contact	Contact channels + a working message form (opens the visitor's email app).

Technical foundation

- Built with **Next.js 15**, **Tailwind CSS 4**, and **Framer Motion** — the same modern stack used by leading product companies.
- All sample content lives in **three simple data files** (events, committee, gallery) — swapping in real content requires no design or code changes.
- Runs at **\$0/month** (free hosting tier); the only future cost is a domain name (~\$12/year).

5. What Will Come in the Future (roadmap)

Phase 2 — Real content & launch ✓ Replace placeholders: real logo, event photos, committee names, organization story ✓ Buy domain (e.g., uthausa.org) and deploy free on Vercel — the site goes live to the public ✓ Connect Facebook/WhatsApp links and real contact email
Phase 3 — Community features ✓ Real events with RSVP ("I'm coming") and automatic email confirmations ✓ News/announcement section the committee can update ✓ Full photo galleries per event; optional Bangla/English language toggle

Phase 4 — Membership & automation (already fully designed, on hold by decision)

- ✓ Online membership signup with automatic confirmations and digital QR member cards
- ✓ Event ticketing with QR e-tickets and a phone-based door check-in scanner
- ✓ Treasurer's admin dashboard and a public transparency ledger
- ✓ Payment options researched and documented (see companion report: *Utha-USA-Money-Guide.pdf*)

6. Summary for Decision

Done: market research of ~28 peer organizations · complete design system · fully animated Version 1 website, built and tested.

Needed next from us: (1) approve the design direction, (2) provide real content — logo, photos, committee list, first real events, (3) choose the domain name for launch.

Our position after launch: the most modern website of any Bangladeshi community organization in the United States, at effectively zero running cost, with a clear path to full membership automation when the organization is ready.